
C5 Commerce and Imperial Expansion, c1815-70

- The importance of the Napoleonic wars for the expansion of the British Empire: growing worldwide influence; colonial acquisitions at the end of the wars and their significance.
- The relationship between the Empire and British industrialisation: the role of the Empire in supplying raw materials for the Mother Country and as a recipient of British-manufactured goods.
- The concept of 'formal' and 'informal' empire; the importance of the navy in securing an imperial presence.
- The concept of the 'Pax Britannica' and the significance of Christianity in development of imperial ideas and attitudes.

C6 Britain and the Scramble for Africa, c1875-1914

- Britain's growing interests in North Africa: acquisition of Suez canal shares and its significance; the concept of an 'informal' empire.
- Nature and extent of imperial acquisitions in Africa in this period.
- Conflict in Southern Africa: reasons for, and consequences of, the two Boer Wars.
- The development of imperial attitudes: British perceptions of the benefits of the Empire for indigenous peoples; advantages and disadvantages of the Empire for the British in this period.

C7 Retreat from Empire: Decolonisation in Africa, c1957-81

- Reasons why the British Empire was difficult to sustain: costs of maintenance; impact of the Second World War; Britain's declining influence in world affairs.
- Reasons for, and nature of, independence movements in Africa in the 1950s and early 1960s: reasons why decolonisation in British colonies in Africa came about so quickly in the 1950s and 1960s.
- Extent to which decolonisation was accompanied by an orderly transition or by violence.
- Attempts at decolonisation in southern Africa: the cases of South Africa and Southern Rhodesia (Zimbabwe), 1960-81.

1.6 Unit 1, Option D: A World Divided: Communism and Democracy in the 20th Century

Focus

This option concentrates on the theme of contrasting ideologies, with particular emphasis on how Communism developed and, in some societies, succeeded in overthrowing existing authority in the first half of the 20th century. This option also concentrates on how the USA responded to the challenge of Communism during that time and on the development of and challenges to democracy in the USA. Whichever combinations are chosen, this option enables students to understand the importance of ideas and beliefs in the policies developed by states, how and why ideology is frequently a cause of both challenge and conflict, within and between states, and also gives rise to debates about the rights of citizens.

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in *Appendix 1*.

Students entered for Option D are required to study TWO of the topics from D1-D7.

D1 Crises, Tensions and Political Divisions in China, 1900-49

- The last years of Imperial China and the Revolution of 1911-12: the impact of foreigners, reformers and revolutionaries.
- Warlords, Nationalists and Communists, 1912-27: the rule of Yuan Shikai; the May 4th movement; Sun Yat-sen and the revived Guomindang (GMD — Chinese People's Party).
- Nationalist triumph and Communist survival 1927-37: the Shanghai Massacre; the Jiangxi Soviet; the Long March.
- War and civil war, 1937-49: the Japanese assault and its impact; the civil war of 1946-49; reasons for the Communist victory.

D2 Mao's China, 1949-76

- The Government of the People's Republic of China: Mao's authority and ideas; his leading colleagues; the People's Liberation Army; the Hundred Flowers Campaign and its consequences.
- The nature of economic policies: agricultural change in the 1950s and early 1960s; attempts at industrialisation; five-year plans and the Great Leap Forward.
- Social changes, 1949-65: gender, class and culture.